Demo Source: Indian Polity essentials

A short demo text for SMRITI. Every fact below sits on the page its atom cites.

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Preamble and salient features. The Preamble promises liberty of thought, expression, belief, faith and worship; it does not mention economic liberty.

Preamble and salient features. The words "socialist" and "secular" were added to the Preamble by the 42nd Amendment Act, 1976.

Preamble and salient features. In Kesavananda Bharati (1973), the Supreme Court held that the Preamble is a part of the Constitution.

Preamble and salient features. In the Berubari Union reference (1960), the Supreme Court held that the Preamble is not a part of the Constitution.

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Fundamental Rights and writs. Untouchability is abolished, and its practice in any form forbidden, by Article 17, part of the Right to Equality.

Fundamental Rights and writs. The right to property was removed from the Fundamental Rights by the 44th Amendment Act, 1978; it is now a constitutional right under Article 300A.

Fundamental Rights and writs. Article 32 guarantees the right to move the Supreme Court for the enforcement of Fundamental Rights.

Fundamental Rights and writs. Under Article 226, High Courts can issue writs to enforce Fundamental Rights and also "for any other purpose".

Fundamental Rights and writs. The writ of habeas corpus ("to have the body") orders the release of a person who is unlawfully detained.

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Directive Principles and Fundamental Duties. The Directive Principles of State Policy are in Part IV of the Constitution (Articles 36 to 51).

Directive Principles and Fundamental Duties. Under Article 37, the Directive Principles are not enforceable by any court, yet fundamental in the governance of the country.

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Directive Principles and Fundamental Duties. Fundamental Duties (Article 51A) were added by the 42nd Amendment Act, 1976, on the recommendation of the Swaran Singh Committee.

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Parliament: composition and presiding officers. The Rajya Sabha can have at most 250 members, of whom the President nominates 12.

Parliament: composition and presiding officers. The Speaker of the Lok Sabha resigns by writing addressed to the Deputy Speaker.

Parliament: composition and presiding officers. Under the 84th Amendment Act (2001), allocation of Lok Sabha seats among States stays based on the 1971 Census until the first Census taken after 2026.

Parliamentary devices: questions and committees. A starred question in Parliament is answered orally, and supplementary questions may follow.

Parliamentary devices: questions and committees. An unstarred question is answered in writing, so no supplementary questions follow.

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Law-making: Money Bills and joint sittings. A Money Bill can be introduced only in the Lok Sabha, and only on the President's recommendation.

Law-making: Money Bills and joint sittings. The Rajya Sabha must return a Money Bill within 14 days, with or without recommendations.

Law-making: Money Bills and joint sittings. A joint sitting of the two Houses under Article 108 is presided over by the Speaker of the Lok Sabha.

Law-making: Money Bills and joint sittings. No joint sitting can be held on a Money Bill or on a Constitution Amendment Bill.

Rajya Sabha and the States. The Rajya Sabha (Article 80) is the Council of States: a permanent House whose members are elected by the State Legislative Assemblies. Representation: members are elected by elected MLAs through proportional representation by single transferable vote. Federal powers of its own: Article 249 (Parliament may legislate on a State List subject) and Article 312 (new All India Services). Revising chamber: an equal say on ordinary and Constitution Amendment Bills, a check on hasty legislation. Limits: only 14 days on Money Bills, and at a joint sitting the larger Lok Sabha prevails.

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Amendment and the basic structure. Landmark cases on Parliament's power to amend Fundamental Rights, in order: Shankari Prasad (1951), Golaknath (1967), Kesavananda Bharati (1973) and Minerva Mills (1980).

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Panchayats and municipalities. Panchayats got constitutional status through the 73rd Amendment Act, 1992, which added Part IX.

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Constitutional bodies. The Finance Commission is constituted by the President under Article 280 every fifth year, or earlier if needed.

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Union executive: President, Vice-President and ministers. C. P. Radhakrishnan was elected Vice-President of India on 9 September 2025, after Jagdeep Dhankhar resigned in July 2025.

Union executive: President, Vice-President and ministers. The Constitution (130th Amendment) Bill, 2025 would remove a Prime Minister, Chief Minister or minister held in custody for 30 consecutive days on charges punishable with five or more years.

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